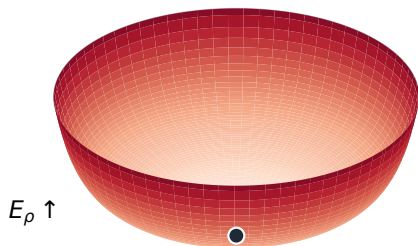


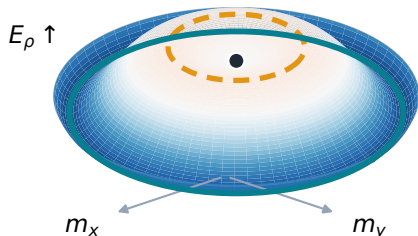
Polarization-vector section $m_z = 0$ (not physical space)

$\rho = 1.8$



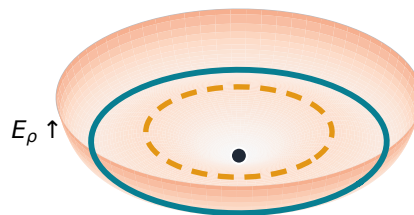
m_x m_y
One well: uniform state

$\rho = 2.0$



m_x m_y
Two wells: favored order

$\rho = 1.9$



m_x m_y
Two wells: metastable order

Physical reading

- central well: uniform state
- barrier ring
- ordered ring well

The ring is directional degeneracy at fixed order; in the full polarization space it is a sphere.

Height/color: exact free-energy envelope

This is not a vMF closure of the original PDE.

